

phi adajar

they/them

mit department of economics

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education

2021– PhD Candidate in Economics, MIT
2017–2021 SB in Mathematical Economics, MIT

research

areas Education, Labor, Market Design
advisors Parag Pathak, Esther Duflo

in-progress

- 1 **No Strings Attached: The Effects of Unraveling in UK College Admissions**
with Nagisa Tadjfar, Kartik Vira.
- 2 **Identifying and Nurturing Math Talent: An Experiment with Self-Paced Classes in Tamil Nadu**
with Esther Duflo, Glenn Ellison, Sara Fisher Ellison, and Harini Kannan.
Presented at NBER Economics of Talent Meeting, Fall 2025; NBER Economics of Education Meeting, Spring 2026.
- 3 **From Cubs to Bears: Differential High School Access in Chicago**
with Parag Pathak.
- 4 **Improving Finite-Sample Estimation of School Effects**
- 5 **School-House Shocks: The Effect of Neighborhood-based School Assignment Policies on Intracity Migration**

affiliations

2022– Blueprint Labs, Research Associate

research assistantships

2022 Parag Pathak, MIT
2018–2021 Ernst Berndt and Rena Conti, MIT
2020 Ben Olken and Gabriel Kreindler, MIT + Harvard

undergraduate work

2021 [link](#) Evaluating Strategic Play: Manipulations with Symmetric Information in the Boston Mechanism
Thesis advised by Parag Pathak.

2021 [link](#) A Rising Tide for All or Wave for One? The Effect of Charter School Competition on District Achievement
Selected for MIT Undergraduate Journal of Economics, Vol. XX.

2019 [link](#) The Surprising Hybrid Pedigree of Measures of Diversity and Economic Concentration
with Ernie Berndt and Rena Conti. NBER Working Paper #26512.

teaching

2025 Kaufman Teaching Certificate, MIT Teaching + Learning Lab
2023 MIT 14.19 (UG Market Design), TA for Parag Pathak (rating 6.6/7)
2021 MIT 14.02 (UG Principles of Macroeconomics), TA for Ricardo Caballero (rating 6.5/7)
2019 MIT 14.27 (UG Economics and E-Commerce), TA for Sara Ellison (rating 5.5/7)

leadership + service

refereeing

Econometrica

2025–	Graduate Representative, MIT Committee on Undergraduate Admissions and Financial Aid
2022–	Graduate Resident Advisor, MIT Division of Student Life
2023	Graduate Representative, MIT GRA Training Committee
2022–2023	Labor Coffee Organizer, MIT Department of Economics
2021–2024	Educational Counselor (admissions interviewer), MIT Alumni Association
2020–2021	Undergraduate Representative, MIT Committee on the Undergraduate Program
2020–	Alumni Volunteer, National Science Bowl
2019–2021	Regional and invitational coordinator, invitational founder, MIT Science Bowl
2017–2021	Chair, program director, MIT Educational Studies Program

awards + fellowships

2025–2026	Hausman Dissertation Fellowship, MIT Department of Economics
2025–2026	NBER Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, Global Math Talent
2021–2026	NSF Graduate Research Fellowship
2021	Phi Beta Kappa, MIT
2020	Burchard Scholar, MIT

grants

uk unraveling

2023–2026	George and Obie Shultz Fund (×5)
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math talent

2025	Carina Initiatives
2024	Founders Pledge
2023, 2024	Agency Fund
2023	J-PAL Science for Progress Initiative

potpourri

music/theater	The Wedding Party (Secret City Adventures/Green Door Labs, 2026), Romancing Jan: Love and Labor (Incantrix Productions, 2026), Michael in “tick, tick... BOOM!” (2024), Kevin in “Remembering Her” (2023), Centrifuges Music Director (2022)
puzzlehunts	Strategy captain for NES (4 th place MIT Mystery Hunt 2025), puzzle writer for Green Door Labs (Cthulhu Luau , Club Drosselmeyer), consultant for FableVision Studios (HMNH Puzzle Party)
crosswords	Daily NYT solving since 2022, perennial Boswords competitor, author for 2025 MIT Crossword Open
interests	D&D, trivia, jazz piano, baking, biking